Team purpose

Vision

Why do we exist as a team?

We exist as a team to develop GoClean, a digital laundry pickup and delivery service that gives university students and busy township residents an affordable, convenient way to get their laundry done. Many of these customers struggle with a lack of time, transport or easy access to affordable laundry services, and traditional laundromats require travel and waiting. Our goal is to reduce these challenges by creating a web-based platform that allows customers to place, schedule and track laundry orders from their phones.

Team Mission

Our mission is to solve the problem of inconvenient and costly laundry access for university students and low-to-middle income residents of District 6 and surrounding Cape Town communities. We aim to achieve this by developing a web application, built with Java (Spring Boot) and a MySQL database, that enables customers to book a pickup, track their order and receive their clean, washed, dried and folded clothes at their door. Our idea was refined after lecturer feedback: we pivoted from a public clinic booking system, which required heavy funding and government support, to a laundry service with no dependence on large institutions, a clear income model (payment per basket or monthly package) and a lower technical and financial barrier to build and test.

Success Definition

We will consider our team successful if:

· We develop a functional web application that lets customers order and track laundry pickup and delivery

· Customers can place orders easily and efficiently through the platform and WhatsApp/social media channels

· We meet our two-week pilot targets (20 Google Form responses, 15 “Yes” responses to using the service, 8 paid orders, 20 social media likes/shares and 4 positive customer ratings)

· All team members contribute effectively and follow Agile practices

· We can clearly demonstrate that our solution solves the identified problem and is financially feasible (estimated startup cost of approximately R6,500)

Testing real demand through a Minimum Viable Product (MVP) before investing significant time or money is a widely recognised way to validate a new business idea.

Service

We are responsible for delivering an affordable laundry pickup and delivery service, supported by a web application, for students and township residents.

The system will:

· Allow customers to register, log in and place laundry orders online

· Provide order tracking from pickup through to delivery

· Keep an order history for returning customers

· Support scheduling and payment per basket or monthly package

· Improve efficiency for both customers and delivery drivers

This solution is designed around the 5W marketing framework: it targets customers aged 18–40 on a low-to-middle income who value convenience, time saved and peace of mind.

Roles and Responsibilities

The GoClean laundry service is a collaborative project involving a team of five members. Each member's role is clearly defined to divide teamwork and project execution into manageable components. These tasks are intended to clarify responsibilities, organise individual contributions, and ensure accountability for each aspect of the project. By applying their individual expertise, the team aims to develop a functional laundry pickup and delivery platform that meets the required needs and fulfils its intended purpose.

Team Member	Role	Responsibilities
Nomhle Njengele	Developer	Engages in system development using Java (Spring Boot) and MySQL, and produces relevant project documentation by organizing information within the system.
Lerato Nadine Letsoele	Product Owner	Gathers and evaluates system requirements, defines customer requirements and maintains the project's alignment with its purpose throughout its development.
Oratilwe Catherine Komane	Scrum Master	Supervises team processes through task coordination, facilitation of internal communication, implementation of Agile methodology and monitoring of project progress and deadlines.

Solomon Elias Machaule	UI/UX Designer	Designs the system interface and Figma wireframes and makes them intuitive and user-friendly for the users of the system, such as the customers and drivers of the GoClean platform.
Thandeka Chantal Malande	Tester (QA)	Coordinates the presentation of projects, performs system testing, detects errors and confirms that the finished project meets defined quality criteria.

Team Values and Principles

Core Values

· **Respect** — We respect each other's time, ideas, and contributions. We also respect the customers our project serves by ensuring our solution genuinely addresses their needs.

· **Transparency** — We communicate openly about progress and blockers, so the whole team always knows where the project stands.

· **Accountability** — Each member owns their tasks. If a deadline cannot be met, we notify the team early so adjustments can be made without pressuring others.

· **Trust** — We trust each other to deliver quality work without micromanaging, while remaining available to support one another.

· **Learning mindset** — We treat every sprint and piece of feedback as an opportunity to grow. As students applying Agile to a real-world problem, we learn through doing, reflecting, and improving.

Agile Principles

1. **Customer collaboration** — We continuously validate our solution against the real needs of students and township residents.

2. **Responding to change** — We adapt our approach based on feedback received after each sprint, as we did when we pivoted after our lecturer’s feedback.

3. **Working solution over documentation** — Our priority is a functional laundry platform, not just reports and paperwork.

4. **Individuals and interactions** — We value open team communication above rigid processes and tools.

5. **Continuous improvement** — Every retrospective produces at least one actionable improvement for the next sprint.

Communication Plan

1. Purpose of the Communication Plan

The purpose of this communication plan is to ensure that all stakeholders involved in the GoClean laundry pickup and delivery service are informed and able to use the system effectively. Good communication will help reduce confusion, improve coordination, and support the successful launch of the service in District 6 and surrounding communities.

2. Stakeholders

The main stakeholders in this project are customers (university students and township residents), delivery drivers, our lecturer, and the development team. Customers will use the system to order and track laundry pickup and delivery, while drivers will collect and deliver orders. Our lecturer will provide feedback and assess progress, and the development team will build, maintain and improve the system.

3. Communication Approach

Customers will receive order confirmations, pickup and delivery updates through WhatsApp and the GoClean web application. They will also find us through Instagram, TikTok, Facebook community pages, campus and residence notice boards, and WhatsApp groups. Drivers will receive their daily pickup and delivery schedules through the web application. Our lecturer will receive regular progress updates and demonstrations, while the development team will handle system updates and feedback.

4. Methods

Different communication methods will be used, including WhatsApp, Instagram and Facebook business pages, Google Forms for pre-orders and feedback, flyers designed in Canva, and pop-up stalls at campus or community areas. Real-time communication will be used for order updates, daily communication for driver schedules, and weekly communication for sprint reviews and retrospectives within the team. The two-week pilot test will be used to gather early customer feedback.

5. Roles and Responsibilities

The Scrum Master will oversee team communication, while the development team will handle technical updates. The Product Owner will gather and relay customer feedback, the UI/UX Designer will share design updates, and the Tester will report errors and quality results. The system will also automatically send order notifications and status updates.

6. Challenges and Solutions

Some challenges include limited data and internet access, low-cost phones, and customers who prefer self-service laundromats. These will be addressed by using WhatsApp, designing a simple browser-based system that needs no app

installation, keeping pricing affordable, and highlighting the convenience of door-to-door pickup and delivery.

7. Conclusion

This communication plan ensures that all stakeholders are properly informed and involved. Effective communication will help improve efficiency, save customers time, and support better service delivery for GoClean customers.

References

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